WOUNDS OF WONDERS

SEASON

ONE

Preamble

(Church setting. Japheth and Faith stand at the altar. The Pastor is before them, congregation seated. A quiet, reverent atmosphere fills the stage.)

Pastor: "Dearly beloved, we are gathered here today in the presence of God to witness the holy covenant of marriage between Japheth and Faith. This is a sacred union, ordained by God. Now, Japheth and Faith, it is time to declare your vows before God and His people." (Turns to Japheth.) "Japheth, please repeat after me."

Japheth : "I, Japheth, take you, Faith, to be my wedded wife. To have and to hold from this day forward, for better, for worse, for richer, for poorer, in sickness and in health, to love and to cherish, till death do us part. According to God's holy ordinance, I pledge you, my faithfulness.". (Pastor turns to Faith)

Pastor: "Faith, please repeat after me."

Faith: "I, Faith, take you, Japheth, to be my wedded husband. To have and to hold from this day forward, for better, for worse, for richer, for poorer, in sickness and in health, to love and to cherish, till death do us part. According to God's holy ordinance, I pledge you, my faithfulness." (The couple joins hands. Pastor smiles warmly.)

Pastor: "It has indeed been a journey of ups and downs for these two to arrive at this precious day. But today we witness the grace of God in their lives. Let us look back and see how their journey unfolded."

(Lights slowly fade. A flashback begins. All exit stage.)

Scene 1

(Lights up on the Opondo's modest living room. A dining table is set. Miss Opondo sits with her three children—Japheth, Mourine, and John—sharing supper. They laugh and talk joyfully.)

Miss Opondo: (smiling) Japheth, I am so proud of you. Your performance in school is a blessing to this family.

Mourine: (clapping) Yes, brother! You make us proud. Maybe one day you'll be the one to lift this family.

John: (teasing) Just don't forget us when you become a big man! (All laugh. Atmosphere is warm and celebratory.)

(Suddenly, the door creaks open. Mr. Opondo staggers in, visibly drunk. His face is hardened, his steps unstable. The laughter dies instantly. He slams the door shut behind him.)

Mr. Opondo: (angrily) What nonsense is this? Eating and laughing like life is perfect? (He looks at the food with disgust, then at Japheth.) And you! Don't think your little grades will change anything in this house! (He flips the plates off the table violently. The children shrink back in fear. Miss Opondo shields them.)

Miss Opondo: (pleading) Please, Opondo… not in front of the children.

Mr. Opondo: (roaring) Out! All of you, OUT!

(He pushes them toward the door. The children cry softly. Miss Opondo gathers them, trembling. Mr. Opondo shoves them outside and slams the door, locking it. The family huddles together outside the house, in the cold and dark. Lights fade.)

Scene 2: School Staffroom – Afternoon

(Lights up. A few teachers sit around a table, papers and files scattered. The mood is serious. One teacher flip through Japheth's report forms.)

Teacher 1): (frowning) Colleagues, I'm concerned. Japheth's performance has dropped sharply this term. From top of the class… to below average.

Teacher 2): (shaking her head) It's so unlike him. Japheth has always been disciplined, focused, and hardworking.

Teacher 3: (thoughtful) Students don't just change overnight. Something must be going on—either at home or among his friends.

Teacher 2: I agree. If we just let it slide, we might lose a very bright boy.

Teacher 1: (nodding) Then let's not guess. We should call him here… ask him directly what's troubling him.

Teacher 3: Yes, but gently. We must show him that we care, not that we are interrogating him.

Teacher 2: (firmly) Good. Then let's send for him after classes today.

(They all nod in agreement. The atmosphere is serious but concerned. Lights dim slowly as the teachers continue murmuring in low tones, planning how to approach Japheth.)

Scene 3: Club – Late Night

(Lights up. Loud music plays faintly in the background (RHUMBA songs). Coloured lights flash across the stage. A round table is set with bottles and glasses. Mr. Opondo sits at the centre, drunk but lively, surrounded by two or three women. He waves money in the air, laughing boisterously.)

Mr. Opondo: (slurring) Drinks for everyone! Tonight, no one leaves sober—ha! (He pours alcohol carelessly, spilling some on the table. The women laugh and clap, egging him on.)

Woman 1: (flirting) Eh, Opondo, you're such a generous man!

Mr. Opondo: (grinning) Money is meant to be enjoyed, not buried in the house with problems! (He pulls out some cash and throws it on the table. The women quickly grab it, laughing louder.)

Woman 2: You're the king of this place!

Mr. Opondo: (leaning back proudly) At home they think I'm useless… but here… here I'm the boss! (He gulps down another drink, wipes his mouth roughly, then stands up unsteadily. He takes off his wristwatch and hands it to one of the women. Boasting) For you, my queen! Nothing is too expensive when Opondo is in charge!

(The women cheer and cling to him. The music grows louder as he laughs uncontrollably, almost falling. Lights dim slowly, leaving the scene hanging in chaos and reckless indulgence.)

Scene 4 (Opondo's Home – Morning)

(A modest living room. Miss Opondo is arranging things as Mr. Opondo sits lazily, reading a newspaper or looking restless. Japheth's school bag is placed at the corner, suggesting he left earlier. The atmosphere is tense.)

Miss Opondo's (softly, trying to remain calm) Opondo… we need to talk. The children need school fees, and we also have no food left in the house. Please, I'm asking you…

Mr. Opondo: (slams the table, rising in anger) Woman! Every day it's money, money, money! Do you think I am a machine? I provide when I want! Stop nagging me!

Miss Opondo: (pleading, holding her hands together) These are your children too… Japheth has been performing so well, but without school fees…

Mr. Opondo: (interrupting, shouts furiously) Shut up! I said enough! (He grabs her roughly. In the struggle, he shoves her violently. She stumbles backward, hits her head on the wall, and falls still. Silence falls suddenly. Mr. Opondo stares at her in shock, breathing heavily, whispering in disbelief) No… no, no… what have I done?

(At that moment, Japheth rushes in cheerfully, but freezes at the sight of his mother on the floor. He drops his books and screams.)

Japheth: (crying, kneeling beside her) Mum! Mum! Wake up, please! Mum!!

(The commotion attracts neighbours, who rush in, gasping at the scene. Some begin shouting and wailing. A neighbour calls the police. Soon, two officers enter, take notes, and cover the body as Japheth continues crying uncontrollably.)

Neighbour 1: (shaking head) How could you, Opondo? How could you do this to your own wife?

(Police escort Mr. Opondo away as Japheth is comforted by neighbours. Lights dim slowly, leaving Japheth sobbing over his mother's covered body.)

Scene 5: (Political rally – afternoon)

(A large crowd is gathered. People wave placards and cheer. A microphone is set up. Local leaders sit at the front. The Local MCA steps forward, raising his hand to silence the crowd.)

MCA: "My good people, today we are gathered not just for politics, but to stand with one of our own. The Opondo family has suffered a great tragedy. Their mother, a woman of strength and sacrifice, is no more. But hear me clearly — Japheth and his siblings will not walk this journey alone. As your MCA, I promise to fully support them in their education, in their welfare, and in building a brighter future. No child in this ward should be denied an opportunity because of misfortune.

Together, we shall raise Japheth and his siblings. Together, we shall prove that a community is stronger than its pain!"

(The crowd cheers loudly, chanting Japheth's name. Japheth, Mourine, and John stand quietly at one side, looking overwhelmed. Some neighbours come forward to embrace them. Music swells as the scene slowly fades.)

Scene 6: (MCA's home – late afternoon)

(Japheth, Mourine, and John stand outside the MCA's tall gate. They look nervous and weary, holding a small envelope of school documents. There is silence for a moment before Mourine speaks.)

Mourine (softly): "Do you think he'll really help us, Japheth? Or were those promises just for the crowd?"

Japheth :(trying to sound confident) "He has to. He said it in front of everyone. A leader's word should mean something."

John: (shaking his head) "Leaders only care when people are watching. Once the cameras leave, so does their kindness. I don't trust him."

Japheth: (sighing, but firm) "Let's give him a chance. Mama always told us to hope… maybe today he'll keep his word." (Japheth steps forward and knocks on the gate. A house-help appears, frowning.)

House-help: "What do you want?"

Japheth :(politely) "We came to see the MCA. He promised to help us after our mother died."

(House-help looks them up and down, then lets them in reluctantly. They walk to the veranda where the MCA is seated in an armchair, scrolling on his phone. He glances up, irritated.)

MCA :(coldly) "Eha, what is it now?"

Mourine :(timidly) "Sir, we… we don't have school fees or food. You promised to support us."

MCA: (snapping) "Do you think I am made of money? Promises are for rallies. Go and tell your problems to someone else."

John: pleading) "But you said in front of everyone that you'd…

MCA: (angrily cutting in) "Enough! Don't lecture me. Get out before I call the watchman!"

(He signals to the house-help, who pushes them roughly toward the gate. The siblings find themselves outside again, the heavy gate slammed behind them. Mourine begins to weep quietly. Japheth clenches his fists, staring at the gate with burning eyes. John looks away, defeated. Lights fade slowly.)

Scene 7: (Story za Jaba)

Scene 8: (Church elder's home – afternoon)

(Stage set: A simple homestead. Elder sits outside reading a newspaper. His wife is nearby, peeling vegetables. Japheth, Mourine, and John Walk in hesitantly, looking tired and desperate.)

Japheth: (respectfully) Good afternoon, Elder. We came to seek your help. Things have been very hard for us since mother died.

Elder: (without looking up) Hm. And what do you expect me to do about it?

Mourine: (pleadingly) Elder, we haven't eaten since yesterday. Please, even a little food…

John: (weak voice) Or maybe school fees, sir. We don't want to drop out.

Elder: (snaps, lowering the newspaper) Do you think I am made of money? You children are not my responsibility. Go back where you came from!

Elder's Wife: (softly, troubled) My husband, please… remember these are orphans. At least give them something small.

Elder: (angrily) Woman! Don't interfere in my matters. Let them leave at once!

Japheth: (hurt, but trying to remain composed) Elder, we thought the church would stand with us. But since you have refused… God will provide.

Elder: (stands and points to the gate) Enough of your preaching! Out of my compound before I lose my temper!

(The children slowly turn and walk out, holding hands. Elder's wife wipes her tears as she watches them leave. Elder angrily sits back with his newspaper, pretending not to care. Lights fade out briefly, then fade in on the siblings walking along a dusty path.)

Mourine: (teary) Why does everyone chase us away? Don't they remember Mama served in that same church with all her heart?

John: (sadly) Maybe we don't belong anywhere anymore. Maybe no one cares about us.

Japheth: (firm but gentle) No, John. Don't say that. Mama always told us never to give up, no matter how hard things get.

Mourine: But Japheth… how will we survive? We have nothing left.

Japheth: (takes a deep breath) We will trust in God. People may abandon us, but He never will. One day, these tears will turn into joy.

(They hug each other tightly, then continue walking down the path, slowly disappearing as the lights dim.)

Scene 9: (Normal Church Service)

(Congregation is seated. Pastor stands at the pulpit, preaching passionately. The atmosphere is alive but calm. Suddenly, Japheth, Mourine, and John Walk in slowly, looking tired, dirty, and hungry. Their clothes are worn-out. The congregation whispers and stares at them.)

Pastor: (Breaks his sermon and watches them keenly) "My children, come forward. Do not be afraid."

(The three walk hesitantly to the front. The congregation looks on in silence. The Pastor descends from the pulpit, gently holds Japheth's shoulder.)

Pastor: "These are our children. Life has wounded them, but we cannot sit and watch while they suffer. The Word tells us to bear one another's burdens. Today, I challenge you—what will we do for these ones?"

(The congregation murmurs in guilt and compassion. A short silence. Then Nancy, a middle-aged woman, stands boldly and walks forward.)

Nancy: "Pastor, I may not have much, but I have a home. I have no children of my own, and God has placed a burden in my heart for them. If Japheth and his sister are willing, I will take them in as my own."

(The congregation claps softly in approval. Tears flow from some eyes. Mourine holds Nancy's hand, emotional. Japheth, weak but relieved, looks at Pastor.)

Pastor:(Blessing Nancy) "May the Lord reward your kindness. This is what true religion is— to

Scene 10: (Stori za Jaba)

Scene 11: (Two Years Later – Church Fellowship)

(Church hall. Congregation is gathered, singing a chorus ("Nipishe njia nipeni nafasi,,,,,,,,,,,,,), Japheth, now grown and confident, sits beside Nancy. The Pastor calls for testimonies. Japheth stands up. Everyone turns to him.)

Japheth: (Breathing in deeply, voice steady) "Brethren, I stand here today to glorify God. Two years ago, I was a broken young boy—homeless, fatherless, motherless, and hopeless. But God, in His mercy, sent me a mother through our dear sister Nancy." (Nancy lowers her head humbly, moved.) "She gave me shelter when I had none, love when I was abandoned, and hope when I thought my life was over. Through her care, I have completed high school successfully, and by God's grace, I have qualified to join university."

(The congregation claps joyfully. Pastor nods in approval. One elder—the same who had once rejected Japheth—shifts uncomfortably in his seat.)

Pastor: "Hallelujah! This is the doing of the Lord, and it is marvelous in our eyes. Japheth, you are a testimony that God lifts the lowly and sets them among princes." (Japheth looks towards Nancy, eyes teary.)

Japheth: "Mama Nancy, thank you for being God's vessel in my life. May He reward you richly." (Nancy stands, holding Japheth's hand.)

Nancy: "I only did what the Lord placed in my heart. My job is to see you shine in God's purpose."

(The congregation claps. The elder who once rejected Japheth finally rises hesitantly.)

Elder: (Voice trembling) "My son… forgive me. I was blind with pride. Today I rejoice to see what God has done. May you succeed in your studies."

(A heavy silence. Japheth nods slowly, extending his hand. They shake. The congregation erupts into applause.)

Pastor: "This is reconciliation, the true heart of Christ! Church, let us continue to support this young man as he prepares for university."

(The choir bursts into a celebratory song. Lights fade.)

Scene 12: (Bible Study Group – Evening, Church Hall)

(A group of young people sit in a circle with open Bibles. Faith, the leader, stands smiling, ready to guide.)

Faith: Welcome back, everyone. Today's verse is Romans 8:28 — "And we know that all things work together for good to them that love God…" What does this mean for us?

Brian :(group member) To me, it means even when we fail in school or in life, God can turn those moments into lessons that shape us.

Mary: (group member) Yes. When I lost my job last year, I thought it was the end. But now, I see God used that to push me into a business that's thriving.

Lavender: (softly, a little emotional) For me… this verse is very personal. I went through a heartbreak recently. I felt broken and abandoned. But now, I'm beginning to see that God can heal and even use that pain to make me stronger.

(The group nods empathetically. Faith walks closer to her with a reassuring smile.)

Faith: Thank you, Lavender. That's powerful. Our scars can become testimonies of God's goodness. (turning to Japheth) Japheth, would you like to share?

Japheth :(hesitant but honest) Life hasn't been easy for me either. Sometimes I wonder if God still sees me. But this verse… it gives me hope. Maybe one day all the pain will have meaning.

Faith: (gently) Thank you for opening up. Remember, you're not alone. God is faithful, and we're here to walk with you.

(Faith leads a short prayer. Members begin leaving. Lavender lingers, looking at Japheth with quiet admiration.)

Lavender: (smiling faintly) Japheth, your words encouraged me. It feels good to know I'm not the only one who's been through pain.

Faith: (warmly) That's the beauty of fellowship — we carry each other's burdens. Japheth, keep coming. This group is family.

(Japheth smiles gratefully. Faith's compassion draws him closer, while Lavender, still healing from heartbreak, begins to sense a new kind of hope as she watches the bond forming.)

Scene 13: (Casual meeting – after CU service)

(Students stream out after service. Japheth notices Lavender walking alone, her expression heavy. He gently approaches.)

Japheth: Lavender… your steps look heavy today. What's weighing you down?

Lavender: (sighs, forcing a smile) Some scars don't fade quickly. Heartbreak makes you feel like your heart is divided by zero …undefined.

Japheth: (softly)Then let me be the constant that steadies your equation.

Lavender: (glances at him, curious) And if I fail again?

Japheth: Failure doesn't cancel destiny. Even when a line breaks, the Author of life still draws it straight. He who began a good work in you will carry it to completion.

Lavender: (pauses, touched) But my heart feels fragile.

Japheth: (steps closer, voice tender) Fragile glass still reflects the brightest light. And love… true love… bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, endures all things.

Lavender: (blushing slightly) You really think I'm worth the risk?

Japheth: (smiles warmly) You are more than worth it. When our paths intersected, I knew it wasn't chance — it was written. Just as two bodies attract by an unseen force, my heart is drawn to you. And just as Scripture says, "Two are better than one, for they have a good reward for their labour," I believe our union can glorify God.

Lavender: (eyes glisten, voice soft) Japheth… you speak as though love is both science and scripture.

Japheth: (takes her hand gently) Because love is the greatest law — greater than gravity, greater than numbers, greater than time. Lavender, allow me to walk this journey with you.

(Lavender hesitates, then nods slowly, a small smile breaking through her pain.)

Lavender: Alright… let's give it a try.

(They walk off together as the stage lights dim, hinting at a love story birthed in faith, wisdom, and healing.)

Scene 14: (Faith counselling Japheth)

(Church compound, evening. Faith and Japheth are seated under a tree after Bible Study. Japheth looks thoughtful, almost troubled. Faith notices and speaks gently.)

Faith: Japheth, can I speak to you as a sister?

Japheth:(softly) Of course, Faith. You've always been a voice of reason in my life.

Faith: (smiling warmly) I can see something is weighing on your heart. You've been spending time with Lavender, haven't you?

Japheth: (sighs) Yes… she has been through so much. I feel drawn to her pain. I want to be there for her.

Faith: That is noble, Japheth. But remember—when someone is wounded, sometimes they are not seeking true love… just a bandage to cover their pain.

Japheth:(looking down) Are you saying Lavender doesn't really care about me?

Faith: Not exactly. What I'm saying is—her heart is still healing. She may be seeking comfort, not commitment. If you rush in, you could confuse compassion for love, and both of you may end up hurt.

Japheth: (quietly) I don't want to be a rebound in her story…

Faith: Exactly. Take time. Pray. Let her heal. If it is God's will, love will blossom in truth, not in desperation. (Pause. Japheth nods slowly, deep in thought. Faith places a reassuring hand on his shoulder.) Remember, Japheth—love must be rooted in Christ, not in loneliness.

Japheth: (sincerely) Thank you, Faith. I needed that reminder.

(Lights fade as Japheth sits quietly, reflecting.)

Scene 15: (Lavender's House – Evening)

(The room is dimly lit. Lavender is pacing slowly from one side to the other, her face filled with mixed emotions. She speaks in a low, reflective tone, holding her hands together nervously.)

Lavender: (Monologue) "Am I rushing this? Just a week ago my heart was torn into pieces by James. And now Japheth… he's kind, he's patient, he says all the right things. But do I truly love him… or am I just trying to fill the emptiness James left behind? Lord, guide me… I don't want to hurt him, and I don't want to hurt myself again."

(She sighs deeply, rubs her forehead, and sits down. Suddenly, there's a knock at the door. Lavender quickly composes herself, forcing a smile, and walks to open the door. Japheth stands there, cheerful.)

Japheth:(smiling warmly) "There's the beautiful smile I was missing today."

(They hug gently. Lavender clings a little tighter than usual, as if hiding her heaviness. Japheth pulls back slightly, looking at her eyes.)

Lavender:(playfully) "Why are you staring at me like that? Haven't you seen beauty before?"

Japheth: (laughs softly) "I've seen many wonders—stars, the moon, the rainbow after the storm—but none of them compare to you."

(Lavender blushes faintly, masking her inner struggle. They start playfully chasing each other around the room, laughing as Japheth pretends to catch her.)

Lavender:(laughing as she runs) "You'll never catch me!"

Japheth: (chasing) "Even if I had to cross mountains and valleys, I'd still find you… because you're worth the journey."

(He finally catches her, spinning her gently. They fall onto the couch, still laughing. Japheth leans closer, looking into her eyes.)

Japheth: "You're more precious than rubies, Lavender. Every day with you feels like a blessing from above."

Lavender:(smiles, but her eyes betray a hint of uncertainty) "And you… you make me feel seen, even when I try to hide."

(They embrace again, laughter turning into a quiet, tender moment. Lavender rests her head on Japheth's chest, her face thoughtful but silent.)

Scene 16: (Open ground / Campus scene)

(The campus open ground. Students pass by in the background. Lavender is standing alone, looking conflicted. James approaches slowly, remorseful.)

James: (softly) Lavender… I know I failed you. I've not had peace since the day I walked away. Please… forgive me.

Lavender: (coldly at first) James, you broke me. You left me when I needed you most.

James: (teary-eyed) I regret every bit of it. I may not deserve your love, but I still love you.

(Lavender breathes heavily, torn inside. Finally, her face softens. She takes a step closer.)

Lavender: quietly) Maybe… maybe I need to let go of the bitterness.

(They embrace. At that moment, Japheth enters, carrying his books. He stops abruptly when he sees them hugging. His face hardens in disbelief. Slowly, he walks toward them.)

Japheth: (**voice trembling)** Lavender… what am I seeing?

(Lavender and James break the hug, startled. Japheth drops his books to the ground with a thud.)

(LIGHTS OFF. END OF SEASON 1)